Clauses

Independent and dependent clauses

1 Independent clause

Makes sense on its own

The bell rang.

2 Noun clause

Acts as a noun (subject or object)

I know that he is honest.

3 Adjective clause

Describes a noun; starts with who, which or that

The book that I bought is old.

4 Adverb clause

Tells when, why, where or how

We stayed at home because it rained.

Spot the clause

A clause has its own subject and verb.

A dependent clause cannot stand alone: it needs a main clause.

Quick test

Although she was tired, she finished the work.

Dependent: although she was tired

Main: she finished the work

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